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Spice up your IE

Did we hear you say that Internet Explorer has no features? With a few plug-ins, it can rival the best

Internet Explorer (IE) may be the most popular, but it's also the most basic of browsers. Just look at Opera or Mozilla—IE lacks pop-up blockers, tabbed browsing and numerous other tiny details that make searching easier.

The good news is that it supports third-party extensions, so you can get most of these missing features installed. We divided all available add-ons into nine different categories—based on the function they perform—and looked for the best in each category.

Remember, if you want to install these add-ons, you need to first start IE, go to **Tools > Options > Advanced** and check the Enable Third Party Browser extensions. Meanwhile, explore the following add-ons that can spice up your explorer. ■

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Add-on Management

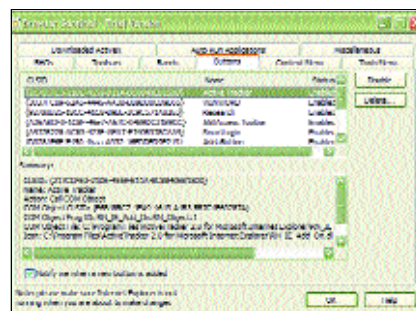
Browser Sentinel

For total control over all installed third-party extensions, you need a program that tells you what's installed where, and monitors new installations too. Presenting...the Browser Sentinel...

Use its interface to view extensions installed in different categories—Browser Helper Objects (BHOs), toolbars, bands, buttons, context menu, tools menu and ActiveX components. It also lets you manage the programs that start with Windows. If you're going to try out the add-ons we have discussed here, install Browser Sentinel first!

Get it on the Mindware CD, or download it from <http://www.unholutions.net/Browser-Sentinel>.

Note that Windows XP SP 2 will have all the features of Browser Sentinel incorporated into IE (See 'Pack 2 The Brim', Page 87).



Pop-Up Blocker

EMS Free Surfer mk II

Pop-up advertisements are undoubtedly the worst irritant. They are created using various techniques, and a good pop up blocker should be able to stop them all. It should also allow the pop-ups you need, be light on memory and be extremely customisable and controllable.

We tested quite a few blockers before deciding on EMS Free Surfer mk II. Some other popular pop-up blockers are Pop-Up Stopper Companion (available at www.panicware.com), and the Google Search toolbar's pop-up blocker.

EMS Free Surfer mk II has two modes—Natural and Strict. Natural mode is the one you use most. In this mode, pop-ups are blocked, but requested windows are opened. In strict mode, no other window opens. It also includes few other features such as a plug-in to cleaning browser caches, home page lock, etc.

EMS Free Surfer mk II blocked unwanted pop-ups, and allowed all legitimate pop-ups. But here comes the best bit, it's a free download from <http://www.emsproject.com/FS>, or you can just pop our Mindware CD into your CD drive. If you want to test how good your pop-up blocker is, log on to www.popuptest.com.

Again, note that Windows XP SP2 has included a pop-up blocker for IE. See page 87 for details.

